

INDUSTRY TREND ANALYSIS

AI selectively scales across the commercial system

Scaling · Evidence current to 27 August 2026

The signal

AI is changing discovery, content, pricing, service, and purchasing, but adoption and control of the customer interface remain concentrated among leading platforms and firms.

41% vs 54%

frequent GenAI use among consumer-and-retail employees versus financial-services and technology employees in the cited survey. ^[1]

**65-80% /
50-65%**

margin ranges cited for AI-enabled software and AI-native products, illustrating why full-stack cost matters. ^[2]

30%

organizations in the 2026 AI at Work survey that had integrated agents into workflows. ^[3]

What is changing - and why it matters

AI is changing discovery, content, pricing, service and purchasing, but adoption is uneven and the customer interface is concentrating among leading platforms. The value question is not only efficiency. It is who controls discovery, first-party data and the moment of decision as agents mediate more interactions.

Executive implication

AI is changing discovery, content, pricing, service and purchasing, but adoption is uneven and the customer interface is concentrating among leading platforms. The value question is not only efficiency. It is who controls discovery, first-party data and the moment of decision as agents mediate more interactions.

Action agenda

- Protect first-party customer data and high-value decision moments.
- Apply AI to end-to-end commercial workflows, not isolated content generation.
- Test incremental margin after platform, model, review and infrastructure costs.

What could change the view

- Customer acquisition becomes dependent on third-party agent interfaces.
- Personalization raises trust or regulatory concerns without increasing conversion.

Selected evidence

[1] Weekly Brief · 2025-07-01 · How Leaders Can Boost AI Adoption In Their Organization

[2] Weekly Brief · 2026-07-28 · The AI Bill Lands on the CEO’s Desk

[3] Weekly Brief · 2026-06-17 · Strategic Clarity Drives AI Value

[4] Weekly Brief · 2026-05-06 · When AI and Cost Become One Agenda

[5] Authoritative research · McKinsey & Company · 2026-06-22 · State of the Consumer 2026: When Tech Acceleration and Cost Pressures Collide

[6] Authoritative research · OECD · 2026-01-28 · AI Use by Individuals Surges as Adoption by Firms Continues to Expand

[7] Authoritative research · J.P. Morgan · 2026-05-06 · Payments Outlook 2026: Five Shifts Powering Payments

This independent analysis connects the available Weekly Brief archive with selected authoritative research. Forecasts and company-reported figures are identified in context. The complete evidence list remains available on the website.